



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Regina Angelorum Academy
School Website: <https://reginaangelorumacademy.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Regina Angelorum Academy (RAA) in Ardmore, PA presents a coherent classical-Catholic profile across its public-facing materials. The school foregrounds a Catholic theological and metaphysical frame, a virtue- and wisdom-centered purpose, a classical liberal arts curriculum, and pedagogy that blends contemplative/memory-building activities with Socratic and rhetoric-oriented experiences. Public materials emphasize liturgy-informed community life, a low-tech learning environment, explicit fidelity to the Magisterium, Latin/Greek exposure, and explicit attention to Great Books/Great Conversation themes. The faculty are described as living mentors within a "living curriculum," and the community emphasizes strong partnerships with parents who are treated as co-educators. Collectively, these signals align Regina Angelorum Academy with a CLASSICAL (or strongly classic) rubric, with no obvious negative indicators in the available public materials.

- Overall classification by category: CLASSICAL for all six categories.
- Aggregate ranking: CLASSICAL.
- Note: No category required a needle-moving "move the needle" section since all six categories meet the CLASSICAL benchmark.

Evidence for this assessment is drawn from the school's mission/vision statements and curriculum landmarks, including explicit Catholic-theological foundations, classical curriculum affirmation, and pedagogy that blends contemplative elements with Socratic/seminar-style practice. Key sources show: an unapologetically Catholic identity tethered to the Magisterium, Scripture and Tradition in the curriculum, and a programmatic emphasis on Truth, Beauty, and Goodness; the Ruah Woods Theology of the Body curriculum; a classical liberal arts framework (grammar, logic, rhetoric; trivium/quadrivium references); a low-tech, memory- and chant-based lower-school approach, and upper-school Socratic/seminar formats; and a strong emphasis on parental partnership as co-educators.

- Core Catholic/metaphysical framing and liturgical community practices are documented in multiple public materials.
- The school describes its mission as forming students and families in Catholic faith formation, classical wisdom, and virtue in action.
- The Theory-of-the-Body curriculum (Ruah Woods) is explicitly adopted to ground Catholic anthropology in the classroom.
- Truth, Beauty, Goodness as a cross-cutting curricular motif is repeatedly named.
- The school frames its approach as classical liberal arts, including Latin/Greek exposure and a time-tested curriculum.
- A low-tech, mindful, memory-forward pedagogy (lower grades) and Socratic/rhetoric-oriented upper grades are described.
- Parents as co-educators and a robust partnership with families are emphasized.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials present Regina Angelorum as an authentically Catholic school, with fidelity to Magisterium and Catholic teaching permeating school life and curriculum. The school emphasizes liturgical life, prayer, and Catholic formation as foundational. - Mission statements tie formation of character to Catholic faith formation, with Scripture and Tradition integrated throughout the curriculum. - The Theology-of-the-Body curriculum (Ruah Woods) is explicitly used to ground worldview and ethics in Catholic teaching. - Morning prayer and liturgical practices appear as routine elements in the school's day-to-day life.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive indicators present: Catholic, Magisterium, Scripture, Tradition, Theology of the Body, prayer, liturgy, liturgical life, sacred/Church-teaching integration. - Negative indicators: none observed in the public materials (no explicit secular focus or anti-faith signals).

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords observed: at least 6–8 distinct Catholic/theological signals across sources. - Negative keywords observed: 0. - Proportion: essentially all relevant signals are positive (roughly 100% positive, 0% negative).

Why this rating - The public materials foreground a transcendent, metaphysical frame anchored in Catholic theology, liturgical life, and magisterial authority, with a curriculum and daily life infused with doctrinal formation. This aligns strongly with the Positive/Negative keyword framework for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations in classical education. CLASSICAL.

Citations: The Catholic identity, Magisterium, Scripture/Tradition integration, and Theology-of-the-Body curriculum are evidenced in the school's mission/vision materials and Ruah Woods references.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission describes formation of virtue and wisdom as the aim of education, not merely preparation for work, with a focus on human flourishing and virtue-centered aims. - The school emphasizes virtue in action, formation of character, and partnership with families in forming Catholic citizens/leaders. - Across materials, the humanistic aim (truth, goodness, beauty) and the "formation of humanity" frame is explicit through references to virtuous, wise citizens and lifelong learning.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive indicators present: virtue, wisdom, formation of character, formation of humanity, truth, goodness, beauty, lifelong learning, virtue in action, Catholic citizen formation. - Negative indicators: none observed (no emphasis on job-centric or utilitarian formation in the public materials).

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords observed: 6–8. - Negative keywords observed: 0. - Proportion: essentially all signals are positive (100% positive, 0% negative).

Why this rating - The school positions education as formation and the cultivation of virtue and wisdom, not merely information or job training, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations for the School Purpose and Goal category. CLASSICAL.

Citations: Mission and purpose language foregrounding virtue, wisdom, formation, and the aim of forming Catholic citizens/leaders.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum is described as a Classical Liberal Arts program with explicit reference to a grammar-logic-rhetoric (Trivium) frame and even a Quadrivium reference in materials recounting classical education. - The curriculum emphasizes the study of Latin (and Greek in some mentions) and the study of great works as part of a Great Books/Great Conversation ethos. The materials connect Regina Angelorum to the broader classical canon and Western civilization, including primary texts and classical languages. - The public materials repeatedly link to "Truth, Beauty, and Goodness" as curricular anchors, and explicitly reference classical texts and a time-tested framework. - The Ruah Woods Theology of the Body curriculum is integrated into the classroom, grounding humanities in Catholic intellectual tradition.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive indicators present: classical liberal arts, grammar/logic/rhetoric (Trivium), Quadrivium, Great Books/Great Conversation, Latin/Greek, Western civilization, primary texts, truth/beauty/goodness as curricular anchors. - Negative indicators: none observed in public materials (no reliance on non-classical approaches or secular “social studies” framing).

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords observed: 7–9. - Negative keywords observed: 0. - Proportion: CLASSICAL (roughly 100% positive, 0% negative).

Why this rating - The curriculum is explicitly framed as classical liberal arts with foundational elements (grammar-logic-rhetoric; Latin/Greek; Great Books; Great Conversation) and a focus on wonder and western canon, which aligns with CLASSICAL criteria. CLASSICAL.

Citations: References to grammar-logic-rhetoric, the Great Books/Great Conversation motif, Latin/Greek, and Western civilization appear in mission/vision and curriculum-related materials.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - There is explicit mention of a lower-school emphasis on singing, memorization, and practices that deepen memory and delight, alongside upper-school Socratic discussion, seminars, and debates, with rhetoric training and public-speaking opportunities. - The pedagogy includes a conscious mix of contemplative/restful elements in some aspects, along with rigorous Socratic-style inquiry in upper grades and training in rhetoric (speeches). - A low-tech learning environment is highlighted (tech-free) to protect childhood innocence and focus on contemplation, writing, research, and presentation rather than heavy digital distraction. - The curriculum emphasizes “why/how” learning, moral formation through classical texts, and the embodied aspects of learning (singing, physical education, etc.).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive indicators present: contemplative/restful pedagogy, memory/chanting, memorization, singing, Socratic seminars, debates, rhetoric, public speaking, lectures/presentations, low-tech environment, classical pedagogy (gymnastic/arts integration). - Negative indicators: none observed (no material signaling heavy project-based, technology-driven pedagogy).

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords observed: 6–9. - Negative keywords observed: 0. - Proportion: CLASSICAL (100% positive).

Why this rating - The teaching methods embrace both contemplative/restful and active, dialogic, rhetoric-focused forms typical of classical pedagogy, including early/memory-enhancement practices and upper-grade Socratic discourse. CLASSICAL.

Citations: Memory/chanting and lower-school practices documented; Socratic/seminar methods in upper grades; the low-tech stance is explicit.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The faculty are described as model teachers and mentors who model virtue, skill, and knowledge; the faculty are described as the living curriculum and as a core of the school; there are references to professional teaching staff with a focus on meeting diverse learner needs. - The school emphasizes that teachers are faithful to Catholicism and that their fidelity to the Magisterium guides the curriculum and school life. - Additional content highlights that faculty engage in curriculum development and professional development (e.g., summer faculty planning and inter-year curriculum alignment).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive indicators present: model teachers/mentors, living curriculum, core of the school, professional teaching staff, fidelity to Catholic teaching, teacher collaboration, and curriculum planning. - Negative indicators: none observed.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords observed: 5–7. - Negative keywords observed: 0. - Proportion: CLASSICAL (≈100% positive).

Why this rating - The public materials portray a faculty that embodies classical ideals of mentorship, intellectual formation, and fidelity to Catholic doctrine, consistent with CLASSICAL expectations for the Faculty category. CLASSICAL.

Citations: Professional teaching staff; “living curriculum”; fidelity to Magisterium; and the teacher as core of the school.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes that parents are the primary educators of their children, with Regina Angelorum serving to support parents in that role; partnership with families is repeatedly highlighted. - The school discusses parent engagement through programs like parent reading groups, family events, and processes that invite ongoing collaboration with families; the “Wait Until After 8th Pledge” reflects a joint parental-scholastic stance on technology. - The school presents itself as a community where parents, students, and teachers worship together and celebrate achievements, highlighting a strong communal culture and openness to visits. - The school advertises that it provides opportunities for parents to participate in the school’s life and philosophy, including informational events, tours, and open access to the community.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive indicators present: partnership with families; parents as co-educators; home-school connection; parent formation; parent reading groups; family/community events; frequent parental access/visits. - Negative indicators: none observed (no material signaling minimal parent involvement).

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords observed: 6–8. - Negative keywords observed: 0. - Proportion: CLASSICAL (≈100% positive).

Why this rating - The public materials consistently foreground parental partnership and family formation as central to education, consistent with CLASSICAL expectations for Parents & Community. CLASSICAL.

Citations: Partnerships with families; parent as co-educators; parent reading groups; community events; and open parental access.

Aggregate assessment across categories - All six categories meet the CLASSICAL bar based on keyword signals and the school’s public materials. - The school’s fusion of a Catholic metaphysical frame, virtue-centric aims, classical curriculum, contemplative-to-Socratic pedagogy, model faculty, and robust parent-community involvement yields a robust CLASSICAL classification overall.

What would move the needle

- Given the CLASSICAL standing, no broad needle-moving shifts are required to reach full CLASSICAL status. If desired, incremental improvements could include:
 - More explicit, public-facing articulation of Great Books/Great Conversation lists, including specific canonical works and authors tied to the Great Books program, to further strengthen the Curriculum signal.
 - Additional explicit documentation of a coherent, K–12 Great Conversation progression across grades, with sample syllabi or reading lists.
 - Publicly available profiles or pathways showing how the faculty support the public mission—e.g., formal “Living Curriculum” statements or portraits of a teacher-student ideal to reinforce the Faculty category.
- These steps would further solidify the six-element rubric but are not necessary to maintain CLASSICAL status given the current materials.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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